STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-8400
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA GREG LONDON SHERIFF	DATE ISSUED 10/10/07	DATE REVISED **03/18/25**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT SCHOOL RESOURCE UNIT OPERATIONS	CROSS REFERENCE G-3310 ROAD PATROL UNIFORMS G-9100 REPORT REQUIREMENTS P-4830 INTERVIEWS IN SCHOOLS			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for the operations of the School Resource Unit.

II. Policy:

The School Resource Unit (SRU) exists to provide for the safety of county schools and to assist in the education of students and citizens regarding law enforcement related issues including but not limited to violence and drug use. SRU deputies are committed to the safety of students and staff, the reduction of crime, providing a peaceful learning environment and improving perceptions and relations between students, parents, school staff, the community and the Sheriff's Office.

III. Procedure:

A. In-Service: SRU deputies shall call in service via radio, and maintain radio contact on their assigned talkgroup, as practical.

B. Criminal Investigations: Consistent with the authority and duties of a sworn law enforcement officer, SRU deputies may undertake criminal investigations that involve students' conduct on or off school property. The SRU deputy conducting the investigation shall notify the applicable school administrator as soon as practicable of any violations or actions that have implications regarding school discipline, order or safety, and other violations as required by law. When conducting formal interviews or interrogations of students, SRU deputies shall adhere to applicable legal standards and Sheriff's Office policy (see P-4830 Interviews in Schools).

C. **Student Contact:** SRU deputies have frequent contact with students as part of their job duties. SRU deputies shall adhere to the following procedures regarding student contact:

1. SRU deputies shall be professional at all times and refrain from any sexual, racial, or insensitive remarks.

2. SRU deputies should avoid removing a student from class for the purpose of convenience. Whenever possible, students should be contacted before or after school, during free periods or during lunch. This does not preclude a SRU deputy from removing a student from class if there is a threat to the safety of students or property or in critical or emergency situations requiring immediate attention.

3. SRU deputies should avoid isolated one on one contact with students of the opposite sex. If required to interview or interrogate an opposite sex student, the SRU deputy should request another deputy/law enforcement officer or school staff member witness the interview/interrogation. If the SRU deputy intends to counsel or speak with an opposite sex student, he or she should do so in a public area or in a location that is visually accessible to other individuals (e.g. in an office with the door open to an occupied common area).

4. SRU deputies are not intended to replace school counselors nor are they to conduct formal psychological counseling. SRU deputies may counsel and advise on the law enforcement aspects of a variety of topics. Student confidentiality shall be maintained as appropriate; however, reports shall be completed as required by policy (see G-9100 Report Requirements).

D. **Confidentiality of Records:** SRU deputies shall have access to school records in which he or she has a legitimate interest related to maintaining the safety of a school. SRU deputies shall maintain the confidentiality of school records and only disseminate such information as necessary for official law enforcement purposes.

E. **Policies and Regulations:** SRU deputies shall be familiar with school policies and regulations related to safety, student conduct, and discipline issues. SRU deputies may be called upon to assist administrators with students who have violated school policy or regulations.

F. **Uniforms:** The standard uniform for SRU deputies shall be the seasonal road patrol uniform (see G-3310 Road Patrol Uniforms). SRU deputies must have prior approval from the Special Services Unit Supervisor to wear anything other than the standard uniform.

G. **No School:** SRU deputies are generally assigned duty hours that coincide with normal school hours. When there is no school scheduled (e.g. holidays and

summer break) or school is cancelled (e.g. severe weather), SRU deputies may choose one of the following:

1. SRU deputies may use compensatory or vacation leave.

2. SRU deputies may work on assigned projects or plan and prepare instruction material as approved by the Special Services Unit Supervisor.

3. SRU deputies are required to perform Road Patrol or Special Services Unit duties as assigned by the Special Services Unit Supervisor.

H. **School Events/Functions:** SRU deputies may be allowed to work after-school events with prior approval from the Special Services Unit Supervisor.

1. If the school event/function is held in Sarpy County, the SRU deputies may attend and work the event in full uniform.

2. If the school event/function is held outside of Sarpy County, the deputies are not allowed to work/attend as a law enforcement officer. Deputies, with prior approval, may attend the event, but not in uniform, unless approved by his/her supervisor.

3. It is the responsibility of each SRU deputy to inform their assigned school administrator(s) of these restrictions for special school events and extracurricular activities.

I. **School Resource Deputies:** The main responsibility of the school resource deputy is the safety of the students and staff of the school to which he or she is assigned. To ensure this goal is met, the following procedures shall be adhered to:

1. School resource deputies shall be armed at all times while on duty at his or her assigned school.

2. If a school resource deputy must leave his or her assigned school, he or she shall notify the Special Services Unit Supervisor.

3. If required to leave his or her assigned school, the school resource deputy shall remain available by radio, pager or cellular phone and shall be able to return to the school for an emergency.

4. If possible, a school resource deputy should make arrangements with a DARE deputy to cover his or her school when absent.

J. **DARE Deputies:** The main responsibility of the DARE deputy is teaching the DARE curricula. To ensure this goal is met, the following procedures shall be adhered to:

1. DARE curricula shall be taught by uniformed deputies who have been trained and certified by a recognized training program. In no event shall the curricula be delivered by a non-certified instructor.

2. DARE deputies should not add, delete, or modify DARE/GREAT curricula, but are encouraged to utilize creative teaching methodology.

3. The use of DARE names, logos, curricula and/or other copyrighted materials, other than in conjunction with presenting the material in schools, must be authorized by the respective organization in writing.

4. DARE deputies should eat lunch with and, if possible, have physical education/recess with a core class during each school day.

5. DARE deputies should avoid taking enforcement action regarding students unless such action is considered an emergency; however, DARE deputies should be prepared to protect students and staff from threats to the safety of the school.

K. **Notification:** School Resource Unit deputies shall immediately notify the Special Services Unit Supervisor of any major incident(s). The Special Services Unit Supervisor shall also be notified in the event of a serious injury involving a student in county jurisdiction schools to ensure notification to school administers.

L. **School Notification:** Deputies assigned to the SRU are responsible for notifying their assigned school when they are absent due to vacation, comp, sick, training, special assignment, etc.